

Conversation

1 What does the woman normally do in the morning?

- A Get up late.
- B Drink a lot of coffee.
- C Make her work plans.
- D Do physical activity.

2 What is one advantage of the man's schedule?

- A He can arrange more time for social life at night.
- B He can have less difficulty coping with meetings.
- C He can enjoy a less distracting work environment.
- D He can be more focused and productive during the day.

3 What do the speakers think determines whether someone is an early bird or a night owl?

- A One's sleep quality.
- B One's work schedule.
- C One's individual body clock.
- D One's attitude toward morning exercise.

4 What should individuals do regarding their schedules according to the speakers?

- A Sleep less to get more work done.
- B Change their natural rhythm to match that of others.
- C Follow a fixed routine regardless of external distractions.
- D Listen to their body and adjust their schedule accordingly.

Scripts

W: Hi, Bob. How are you doing today?

M: I'm good, thanks, Alice. How about you?

W: I'm fine, too. I've just finished my morning run, and I feel energized.

M: Wow, you're such an early bird. How do you manage to wake up so early?

W: Well, I've always been a morning person. I like to start my day with some physical activity and then get to work. It helps me focus and be productive.

M: Interesting. I'm the opposite. I'm totally a night owl. I can't function well in the morning, and I need a lot of coffee and time to wake up.

W: Really? When do you usually go to bed and wake up?

M: I usually go to bed around midnight or later, and wake up around 9 or 10 a.m.

W: Wow, that's late. Don't you feel like you're missing out on the day?

M: Not really. I prefer working at night when it's quiet, and there are fewer distractions. I feel more creative and inspired then.

W: I see. Then do you have any problems with your schedule? Like attending meetings?

M: Sometimes, yes, especially when I have to work with people who are early birds like you. They expect me to be available early in the morning.

W: That must be frustrating. How do you cope with that?

M: Well, I try to adjust my schedule when I have to collaborate with others. But sometimes it's hard to change my natural rhythm.

W: I understand. I think it just comes down to our individual body clocks. Some people are naturally wired to be morning people, while others prefer to stay up late.

M: Yeah, it's fascinating how our bodies work.

W: Exactly. But I guess the important thing is to listen to your own body and adjust your schedule accordingly.

M: Yes, that's a great point. I think there's no one-size-fits-all answer here. Having a routine is essential, regardless of whether you're an early bird or a night owl.

Passage

1 What tasks does the speaker tend to do first every day?

- A The quick tasks.
- B The routine tasks.
- C The most urgent tasks.
- D The most difficult tasks.

2 What is one of the suggestions for getting one's work done in time?

- A Getting up as early as possible to work.
- B Being a night owl and working late at night.
- C Using emails to improve work efficiency.
- D Making use of one's most productive time of day.

3 How does the speaker deal with emails now?

- A She checks and responds to them constantly.
- B She accesses them only during her real work hours.
- C She no longer responds to the most trivial of them.
- D She opens her inbox only when it's totally necessary.

4 What is the purpose of the talk?

- A To discuss the importance of email.
- B To show how to balance work and life.
- C To share some ideas on how to reduce workload.
- D To give some tips on how to work more efficiently.

Scripts:

Have you ever felt you don't have enough hours in the day? Well, here are some ideas that work for me.

First of all, make a to-do list every day and set clear priorities. The trick here isn't making the list; that's the easy part. The trick is setting the priorities. I look at my list and put a star next to anything that is really urgent. Then I put the number "2" next to anything that will just take a couple of minutes. I actually do these quick tasks before I tackle the urgent ones; it's a bit like

clearing the mess off the top of your desk before sitting down to write an important letter. Second, know when is the most productive time of day for you and do your work or study then. One of the shocking discoveries I made about myself is that if I get up at 5 a.m., I can do a day's work and even fit breakfast in before half past nine. Of course, if you are an early bird, it can be difficult to accomplish tasks that involve phoning "night owls", but that's what email's for! Finally, do not let your inbox run your life. I recently realized how frequently I interrupted my real work to check my inbox and respond to the most trivial of emails. So now, I only open it when absolutely necessary, and this saves me hours. If your work depends on you being constantly accessible by email, then you can't do this; but be honest and ask yourself, "Am I an email addict?"

With these simple, practical techniques, you will become more efficient and less stressed, and be able to win some "me-time" for yourself.

Lectures:

Lecture 1

1 What can we learn about verbal behaviors from the lecture?

- A They include both spoken and written language.
- B They ensure that what we say is what we mean.
- C They can convey messages about our personality.
- D They are more complex than nonverbal behaviors.

2 What does paralanguage refer to?

- A Expressing emotions through writing.
- B Making requests with verbal language.
- C Using body language to convey meaning.
- D Using voice in particular ways to communicate.

3 What does the speaker mean by saying "behavior doesn't occur in isolation"?

- A Behavior makes communication complex.
- B Behavior may cause offense to other people.
- C Behavior can be influenced by cultural factors.
- D Behavior plays a vital role in conveying meaning.

4 What is the main purpose of the lecture?

- A To define verbal and nonverbal behaviors.
- B To illustrate the communicative function of behavior.
- C To explain how context affects the meaning of our words.
- D To show how to behave appropriately in different cultures.

Scripts:

Do you realize that every behavior we exhibit serves some type of communicative function? Our

actions and words convey meaning to others, whether we intend them to or not. Understanding the communicative function of behavior can help us better understand ourselves and those around us. Behavior can be divided into two types: verbal and nonverbal. Verbal behaviors include speaking, writing, and even texting or emailing. Nonverbal behaviors include body language, gestures, facial expressions, and tone of voice.

When we engage in verbal behavior, we communicate our thoughts, feelings, and intentions directly through language. We use words to convey information, make requests, and express emotions. However, it's important to remember that what we say isn't always what we mean. For example, sarcasm or irony can change the meaning of our words entirely. Context also affects how our words are interpreted.

Nonverbal behaviors can often be more complex than verbal ones. They can express emotions, convey social status, and communicate messages that we may not be fully conscious of. For example, our posture, eye contact, and facial expressions can all communicate our level of confidence, engagement, and interest in a conversation. Even our clothing and hairstyle can communicate something about our personality and identity.

Another aspect of nonverbal behavior is paralanguage, which refers to the way we use our voice to communicate. This includes intonation, pitch, pace, and volume. The way we say something can convey different messages. Saying "I'm fine" in a cheerful tone can convey happiness, while saying it in a flat or hesitant tone can express the opposite.

It should also be recognized that behavior doesn't occur in isolation. Our actions are influenced by our surroundings and cultural background. This means that what is considered appropriate behavior in one context may not be so in another. For instance, a hug is a common greeting in many Western cultures, but may be considered inappropriate or even offensive in other parts of the world.

Our behavior, whether verbal or nonverbal, plays an important role in conveying meaning. By being aware of our own behavior and how it is understood by others, we can tailor our words and actions to better meet our goals. Similarly, by paying attention to the behavior of others, we can gain insight into their thoughts and feelings, and better understand their perspectives.

Lecture 2:

1 What does the American psychologist suggest as the reason for people failing to implement new behaviors consistently?

- A Lack of a proper approach.
- B Lack of motivation or willpower.
- C The disruption of unhealthy habits.
- D Frequent adjustments of the desired goal.

2 What is recommended by the psychologist as a way to lose weight and improve physical health?

- A Building a better bedtime routine.
- B Following a strict diet and exercise routine.
- C Eating less and doing exercise in the morning.
- D Starting by making small changes like taking short walks.

3 Which is mentioned as a small step for someone to achieve a career goal?

- A Taking the time to actively listen to others.
- B Being conscious enough to express gratitude.
- C Seeking out mentors to gain guidance and support.
- D Building stronger working relationships with others.

4 Why can the “small steps” approach lead to lasting change?

- A It can avoid exhaustion and low motivation.
- B It guarantees immediate results and success.
- C It breaks down goals into manageable tasks.
- D It reduces the time and effort for achieving an objective.

Scripts:

Habits are powerful foundations for our lives. Research shows that they influence around 45 percent of our daily activities. However, adopting new behaviors into our lifestyle can be a major struggle, especially if we're trying to alter unhealthy habits. Fortunately, one reputable American psychologist has some great advice to offer. He suggests that if we're unable to implement new behaviors consistently, it's not always due to a lack of motivation or willpower; it's because we're taking an improper approach. He recommends that, to achieve a desired goal, we should make small, gradual behavioral adjustments instead of immediately jumping into significant changes. This approach can be applied in many aspects of our life.

Take physical health as an example. We often set goals to lose weight or improve our fitness level, but the thought of following a strict diet or committing to a strict exercise routine can be overwhelming. Instead, we can start by making small, sustainable changes, such as starting the day with a healthy breakfast, taking a short walk in the morning, or doing a few minutes of stretching before bed. Over time, these small changes will build up and lead to significant improvements in our overall health and wellbeing.

Similarly, in our careers, we often set ambitious goals for ourselves. We aspire to earn promotions, gain recognition for our work, or pursue new opportunities for career development. However, the path to achieving these goals is often long and filled with uncertainties. To avoid becoming overwhelmed, you should focus on the small steps needed to get there. This might include attending workshops to acquire new skills or knowledge, taking on new responsibilities at work, or seeking out mentors who can provide guidance and support.

When it comes to personal relationships, small steps can have a big impact as well. Building strong relationships requires patience, understanding, and consistent effort. By committing to small, meaningful gestures ---- like expressing gratitude, showing empathy, or simply taking the time to actively listen ---- we can strengthen our connections with others and deepen our sense of belonging.

We're often unprepared for how much time and effort it will take to establish a new behavior. Trying to make big changes all at once leads to exhaustion and decreased motivation. The “small steps” approach celebrates small successes. By breaking down our objectives into manageable tasks and building healthy habits into our daily routines, we can establish a foundation for lasting change.

Keys:

Conversation: D C C D

Passage: A D D D

Lecture 1: A D C B

Lecture 2: A D C C